



This engraving shows children working in an English mill. The size of the first cotton spinning machines meant they were best operated by children.

48

THE MAXIMUM HOURS PER WEEK CHILDREN AGED 9–12 COULD WORK IN ENGLISH MILLS

IN BRITAIN, INDUSTRIAL

development and urban growth progressed rapidly. Laws were introduced to address exploitation of labour and the growing cost of providing for the poor. The **1833 Factory Act** appointed inspectors to monitor factories and limited the hours that children could work.

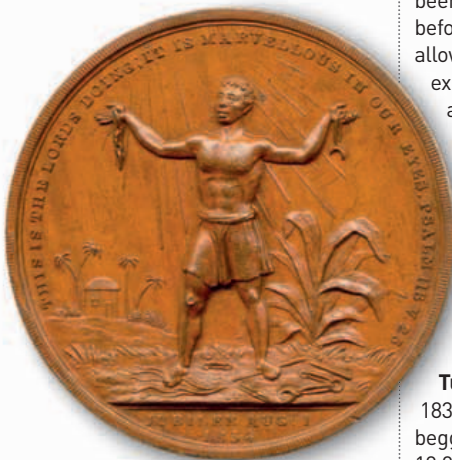
In England, local parishes provided some relief for the elderly, ill, and impoverished. Out of this grew a system of **workhouses**, aiming to give employment to

the able-bodied. The **Poor Law Amendment Act of 1834**

stipulated that the poor could only receive assistance if they went to workhouses, which were to be built in every parish. Conditions in the workhouses were deliberately harsh and the legislation immediately proved unpopular.

In China, British merchants were granted permission to **engage in trade** after legislation ended the East India Company's monopoly. Although there had been private traders in Canton before the act, now more were allowed to sell their wares and export Chinese goods, such as **tea**, the imports of which rose 40 per cent after the beginning of free trade.

In 1832, **Egypt invaded Syria**. Muhammad Ali, the pasha, was angered by a failed promise from the Ottoman sultan to give him the territory. Ali took Gaza and Jerusalem in the **First Turko–Egyptian War**, and by 1833 the Ottoman government begged Russia for help, and 18,000 troops were sent to Constantinople. Britain and France got involved, demanding a settlement, in which Egypt was given Syria, and Russia withdrew.



Commemorative coin

The **Slave Emancipation Act** outlawed the buying or selling of people, set free young children, and compensated planters in most of the British Empire.



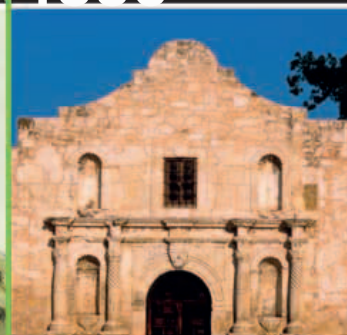
A Galápagos cactus finch, one of the species noted by Charles Darwin.

IN THE PACIFIC OCEAN, almost 600 miles (1,000km) from the coastline of South America, English naturalist **Charles Darwin** (1809–82) took extensive notes on the nature of the **Galápagos Islands**. Darwin had accepted a post on a scientific voyage aboard the *Beagle*, which left England on December 27, 1831, arriving in the Galápagos in September 1835 (see also 1839). It was in the Galápagos where Darwin first noticed the difference in the species of wildlife on the island compared with mainland South America. This discovery laid the foundation for his later scientific work on the **evolution** of different species (see 1859).

In Britain, the **National Colonisation Society** had been set up to facilitate the settlement in Australia of people who were not convicts. Founder **Edward Gibbon Wakefield** (1796–1862)—who had served time in prison—came up with a scheme for populating colonies based on the sale of land and a tax on the price, which would pay for the transportation to the colony. A fleet set off for **South Australia**, where the city of Melbourne was established in 1835, and Adelaide a year later.

“IT SEEMS TO BE A LITTLE WORLD WITHIN ITSELF.”

Charles Darwin, from *Journal of Researches*, September 1835



The Alamo, the site of a key battle for Texan independence.

AS SETTLERS IN THE US MOVED WEST

, many decided to live in the Texas territory, which was part of **Mexico**. However, Mexican authorities wanted tighter control over this large territory and the settlers rebelled in October 1835, launching the **Texas War of Independence**. The following March, after months of unrest, General Antonio López de Santa Anna (1794–1876) marched into Texas with 5,000 Mexican troops. Although massively outnumbered, the rebels managed to hold them off during a battle at a San Antonio fortress, called the Alamo. The rebels were eventually defeated but the Alamo proved a rallying point for Texans bent on revenge. Soon after, General **Samuel Houston** (1793–1863) led a Texan army with the battle cry “**Remember the Alamo!**” and beat Santa Anna at the Battle of Jacinto on April 21, forcing Mexico to recognize the new republic of Texas.

5,000
MEXICANS

182

Texans

Battle of the Alamo

Texans were vastly outnumbered by Mexican forces in the battle fought between 23 February and 6 March and there were very few survivors.



A painting of Queen Victoria's coronation in Westminster Abbey.



Long-distance communicator

This is a single-needle electric telegraph machine, which later developed into double-needle and four-needle instruments.

EXPERIMENTS had been taking place for decades over the question of how to transmit electric current through wires. In 1837, two British inventors, William Fothergill Cooke and Charles Wheatstone, made a breakthrough and secured a patent for an **electric** telegraph device that allowed for communication through wires and had **needles that could point to specific letters and numbers**.

At the same time in the US, **Samuel Morse** received a patent on an electromagnetic transmitter that could transfer information

1833 Slave Emancipation Act abolishes slavery in British Empire, not in force until 1838

1833 Factory Act in Britain prohibits employment of children under age of nine

1834 Poor Law Amendment Act passed in Britain calling for the poor to support themselves

1834 First Carlist War in Spain over succession to the throne (to 1839)

May 5 First railway in continental Europe opens in Belgium

December 1 Danish author Hans Christian Andersen publishes first book of fairy tales

August 30 Founding of the town of Melbourne in Australia

March 2 Texans rebel against Mexican rule and declare their territory a republic

March 6 Defeat of Texans at Battle of the Alamo

Spain recognizes independence of Mexico

October 24 A. Phillips patents the match

December 26 Colony of South Australia officially proclaimed

Death of **Muhammad Bello**, whose kingdom of Sokoto (northern Nigeria) reached a population of around 10 million

Charles Wheatstone and William Cooke patent the telegraph in Britain; **Samuel Morse** in US

March 4 Martin van Buren becomes third US president